

Properties of Technical English

1. Clarity

- Definition: Ideas are expressed clearly without confusion.
- Example: “Connect the red wire to the positive terminal.”
 - Instead of: “Hook up the wire somehow.”

2. Conciseness

- Definition: Uses as few words as possible while keeping meaning.
- Example: “Install the software before starting the machine.”
 - Instead of: “You need to make sure that the software is installed on the computer before turning on the machine.”

3. Accuracy

- Definition: Information is correct and precise.
- Example: “Rotate the knob 90° clockwise.”
 - Instead of: “Turn the knob a bit.”

4. Use of Technical Vocabulary

- Definition: Uses terms specific to the field.
- Example: “Use a torque wrench to tighten the bolt to 50 Nm.”
 - Instead of: “Tighten the bolt as hard as you can.”

5. Objectivity

- Definition: Focuses on facts, not opinions.
- Example: “The motor operates at 3000 RPM under load.”
 - Instead of: “The motor seems fast.”

6. Consistency

- Definition: Standard terms and units are used throughout.
- Example: Always use “kg” instead of sometimes “kilograms” or “kgs.”

7. Logical Organization

- Definition: Information is arranged step by step or logically.
- Example:

1. Switch off the power supply.
2. Open the control panel.
3. Replace the fuse.

8. Use of Standard Abbreviations

- Definition: Common abbreviations are used for efficiency.
- Example: “RPM = 3000” instead of “Rotations per minute = 3000.”

9. Precision

- Definition: Avoids vague expressions; exact numbers or terms are used.
- Example: “Cut the metal rod to 25.5 cm.”
 - Instead of: “Cut the rod to about 25 cm.”

10. Formal Tone

- Definition: Professional, neutral, and avoids casual words.

- Example: “Ensure all screws are tightened before operation.”
 - Instead of: “Make sure all screws are tight.”

11. Unambiguity

- Definition: Each instruction or statement has only one meaning.
- Example: “Press button A for 5 seconds to start the pump.”
 - Instead of: “Press the button to start.”

12. Reproducibility

- Definition: Instructions can be repeated exactly by anyone.
- Example: “Mix 200 mL of solution A with 100 mL of solution B at 25°C.”

13. Conditional Instructions

- Definition: Instructions based on a condition.
- Example: “If the light turns red, stop the conveyor belt immediately.”

14. Documentation-friendly

- Definition: Easy to write or record for reference.
- Example: “Voltage = 220 V, Current = 5 A, Frequency = 50 Hz.”
 - Instead of: “The machine is running normally.”

Exercises

1. Which of the following best describes Technical English?

A) Casual and informal language

B) Clear, precise, and professional language

C) Slang and local expressions

D) Poetry and creative writing

2. Technical English should be:

A) Ambiguous

B) Vague

C) Clear and understandable

D) Full of opinions

3. Which property emphasizes using as few words as possible?

A) Clarity

B) Conciseness

C) Objectivity

D) Precision

4. Using correct terms and measurements in technical writing is called:

A) Objectivity

B) Clarity

C) Accuracy

D) Reproducibility

5. “Rotate the knob 90° clockwise” is an example of which property?

A) Vagueness

B) Precision

C) Ambiguity

D) Casualness

6. Which property focuses on presenting only facts, not opinions?

A) Objectivity

B) Formal tone

C) Consistency

D) Reproducibility

7. Using the same units or terms throughout a document demonstrates:

A) Precision

B) Consistency

C) Logic

D) Clarity

8. Arranging instructions step by step shows:

A) Logical organization

B) Formal tone

C) Objectivity

D) Conciseness

9. Choosing neutral, professional language instead of casual words is called:

A) Formal tone

B) Precision

C) Logical organization

D) Clarity

10. “Mix 200 mL of solution A with 100 mL of solution B at 25°C” is an example of:

A) Conditional instruction

B) Reproducibility

C) Casual instruction

D) Formal tone

11. “If the temperature exceeds 100°C, turn off the machine” demonstrates:

A) Reproducibility

B) Conditional instruction

C) Logical organization

D) Objectivity